

# The Bold Chronicle

VOL. 1, NO. 055

2026-03-30

---

## COVER STORY

# The Big and the Small

*I have a surprise for you. I'll tell you about it in a minute.*

Tim Urban · Wait But Why

I have a surprise for you.

I'll tell you about it in a minute. First, let's have a little fun. Come with me.

I haven't told anyone this before, but I actually live in the fun room. I just gave you a tour of my house, where I spend a large portion of my life thinking about the size of things.

I have visitors in the fun room from time to time, but after a few minutes, they're usually pretty funned out and leave me to my crises. But one day, something unexpected happened.

It was 2013. Wait But Why was a few months old. And I got an email from someone named Philipp Dettmer. I was slightly unsettled by the pp and tt, but I decided to read what he had to say.

He explained that he lives in Germany where he makes animated educational videos about a lot of different things, kind of like Wait But Why but a different medium. I took a look at his YouTube page. It was named a random string of letters:

kurzgesagt

Apparently it means "In a Nutshell" in German, but I didn't know that at the time and was very close to being done with Philipp Dettmer for good when I decided to watch one of the videos.

It was delightful .

I watched another. And another. And then it hit me.

Philipp—this random man in Germany— also lives in the fun room.

The next day, we were on the phone. There was a lot to talk about. We decided we had to do something together, and we settled on adapting one of my early posts into a kurzgesagt video . 1

In the seven years since then, Philipp and I have become great friends, and I have not missed a kurzgesagt video since. Whenever Philipp and I get dinner, we head straight to the fun room to talk about the universe. And a few months ago, we decided to collaborate again. It was time to go public with the fun room.

At some point in our pasts, we had both become enamored with two fun room icons, Cary and Michael Huang, known on the internet as the Huang Twins. The twins do a lot of cool things , but it was their Scale of the Universe toy that we loved most.

Inspired by their work, we decided to go for it. We wanted to make the best size explorer we could imagine. We called it Universe in a Nutshell.

Of course, it took roughly 18 times longer than we thought it would. We brainstormed the interface for quite some time, and then Philipp, along with the incredible kurzgesagt team, dug into working on illustrations and animations, while I worked with the team on the written explainers.

Thousands of human hours later, the app is done. 250 objects, 30,000+ words of explanations and fun facts, just the right mood music, and what we think is a pretty great interface.

Here's how it works:

The app is a giant wall. The wall is impossibly large—large enough to fit full-sized galaxies on it. The wall is also

impossibly high-resolution—hi-res enough to contain sharp images of subatomic particles.

I know it seems weird that I’m talking about it as if it’s a real object, but I have a good reason: to get the full mind-blow effect, you have to realize what you’re looking at. You’re not moving forward and backward through a tunnel of objects—it just seems that way because your brain will refuse to accept the insanity of the actual sizes you’re seeing. By reminding yourself again and again that all of these objects are “painted” on the same 2D wall, you’ll hopefully experience some fun mind-bending moments.

The app looks like this:

And this:

And this:

And there are three ways to zoom:

You can tap any object for an explainer and fun facts. All of the facts you just read in the fun room are also in the app, along with a million other things. (The surprisingly-good-for-Wait-But-Why-illustrations from the fun room are the work of Kurzgesagt. Don’t think this is some new normal.)

Three more things:

1) The app is \$3 in the US store, which, considering the fact that a magical infinite wall should really go for like \$2.5 million, is a huge steal.

2) If you like the app, please give it a rating or review. For example, here’s my review:

3) This is V1 of the app. As we made the app, we had a constant side conversation going on about possibilities for V2, V3, and beyond. We’re launching today, but this is just the beginning. We want this app to be a brain playground that just keeps getting better and better. And here’s where you come in.

As you use the app, whenever you have an “I wish the app did X” or “It would be so cool if the app could do Y” thought, we want to hear it. As this is V1, we of course also want to know whenever you have a “This isn’t working right” or an “I think this fact is off” thought. In the app’s menu, you’ll see a “feedback” tab, where you can tap the feedback email address and let us know what you’re thinking.

Okay, here you go. Click the left app for iPhone/iPad, the right one for Android.

id=“image-map-pro-3124”>

id=“appStores”>

id=“image-map-pro-5888”>

style=“text-align: center;”>\_\_\_\_\_

Also: To commemorate the app launch, Kurzgesagt did their own fun room creation today— a delightful video about the sizes of stars .

style=“text-align: center;”>\_\_\_\_\_

End things:

If you like Wait But Why, sign up for our unannoying-I-promise email list and we’ll send you new posts when they come out.

To support Wait But Why, visit our Patreon page .

style=“text-align: center;”>\_\_\_\_\_

The SpaceX Post

The Quadrillion Sour Patch Kids Post

And a trip to the not-so-fun room

Kurzgesagt did an updated version of the video in 2018. ↩

The post The Big and the Small appeared first on Wait But Why .

{

## FEATURES

# Tracking (Expert/Influential) Predictions about AI

Noah Birnbaum · LessWrong

I think the future of AI is really important, and it would be pretty good to know which experts have been right and wrong about progress and effects. It would be pretty good to keep a website up on important peoples' track records (superforecasters, famous domain experts, frontier lab people, AI 2027, Situational Awareness, etc).

Currently, I think there's an incentive problem where it kinda pays to make vague predictions. This disincentivizes people who are putting their neck out and means it's much more difficult to cut through the noise.

Solution: track imprecise predictions—either by pinning them down precisely or by not evaluating over Brier scores but just giving vibes as to whether it seems like they got it right (flagging for uncertainty).

What I currently have in mind: a site that aggregates from existing platforms like Metaculus, Good Judgment, and Manifold, while also scraping the web for predictions made outside them—interviews, posts, podcasts. When an expert makes a prediction anywhere, someone can submit it to be moderated and added to their record. The goal is a single place where you can look up anyone who people might actually defer to and see their full history, whether or not they ever opted into a forecasting platform. You'd probably want to prioritize the most important predictions from the most important people.

This is different from existing platforms like Good Judgment in two ways. First, it tracks people who never opted in—the forecasters, lab researchers, and public intellectuals who make predictions in interviews, posts, and podcasts but don't put them on a platform. These are often the most influential voices, and right now they face basically no accountability. Second, the UI should make it easy to look up a specific person and see their full prediction history at a glance, which existing tools, imo, make surprisingly difficult.

One note on how to use it: I think the standard on the site should be to have inside views only, which might complicate things. As Thomas Larsen rightly points out, leaning too hard on aggregated reputations risks deference cascades—people updating on each other's records rather than on the object level. After all, I do think that part of LW alpha comes from making inside views/not deferring, and we should fear losing that.

When I last tried building this with Claude Code, it was too difficult to do in one sitting. If someone wants to work on this with me over a weekend, reach out—I'd be curious to see how far we can get.

I think this matters a lot for [ AI for epistemics ], especially if you think those epistemics will be shaken up soon by TAI.

}

One concern worth flagging: this could also create perverse incentives. Someone could build a track record, use it to shift opinion, then make a bad prediction at the worst moment. I think this risk is real but manageable—the tracker is most dangerous if people concentrate their trust in a very small number of highly-rated forecasters, which is itself a bad epistemic practice regardless.

{

# “Path to Victory”

Chris\_Leong · LessWrong

This article is based on reflections from co-leading the Sydney AI Safety Fellowship. This post is primarily focused on AI safety, but I expect the lessons to be more generally applicable.

We have a Problem <sup>™</sup> —actually several problems ; okay even more problems .

Unfortunately, the edge cases make it hard to write down a shared problem statement [1] , but we just need to get on with it regardless, since The Universe Doesn't Have to Play Nice . Consensus on exact problem bounds would likely be net negative anyway, as it would make it much easier to completely neglect at least one value or threat that we would later regret not dealing with [2] .

So let's just assume that we have our problem statement and that it's close enough to other people's problem statement that a community forms around it. This community consists of people with a variety of different skills, temperaments and degrees of commitment. This naturally leads to the question of what aspects different members of the community should be working on. Notably, we need to avoid unrealistic assumptions about there being a centralised authority to draw up a plan and divide tasks. It's not going to happen, and even if centralisation were possible, it would likely just make things worse [3] .

Instead, we need to tackle the problem in a more decentralised manner. But how can we avoid dropping a ball we can't afford to drop without centralised co-ordination?

Well, whatever we do, we need to take into account that there is variation in commitment and ability. Some people are willing and able to take Heroic Responsibility [4] , using risky techniques like Shut up and do the impossible! — others are not. Indeed, I suspect that very few people (or groups) will be capable of taking heroic responsibility for the whole problem. I was persuaded of this by an X [5] by Richard Ngo:

This resonates strongly with me, though I'd frame it in terms of taking heroic responsibility for short timelines. I expect working on short timelines to be much less intense if you're only biting off a small chunk of the problem, so I predict a wider range of people could work on this than Richard expects [6] .

In any case, this is where we are: we have a small number of people who can take heroic responsibility for the whole problem and a much larger number of people who can't [7] . The people who can't take heroic responsibility should primarily focus, focus, focus and pick one thing they can do well. I resonate strongly with how EA thinks about prioritisation, but I differ in that I think more in terms of systems [8] and less in terms of direct, measurable impact. To be specific, I tend to think more in terms of interventions as

building blocks (such as gathering resources or discovering information) that others can attempt to build on top of [9] —be it incrementalists laying one more brick or Heroes<sup>™</sup> shaping it into a working plan [10] .

I feel that there's a broad understanding that many of EA's old mental models of how to think about impact don't really carry over from EA's global health beginnings to the AI safety context, but we never really developed proper replacements [11] . I think it's important to understand that there are different kinds of domains. Universal tools or mental models would be ideal, but this is extremely hard, perhaps even impossible. Producing tools to solve the problem in front of you feels much more viable. What I've described above fills in some of the blanks, but it needs to be developed in more detail.

I think it's worth stepping back and asking what would need to happen for this plan to succeed:

value="1"> Firstly, we need more people to ask themselves whether they'd be willing to step up to take heroic responsibility . I suspect very few people have deeply grappled with this question. For most people, grappling with it would mean confronting the possibility that things could be quite dire. Why else would you choose to suffer that much? Confronting catastrophic—let alone existential—risk is hard. Sure, we talk about it all the time, but mostly just on an intellectual level. Confronting this emotionally is truly something else. Secondly, if you're hitting home runs with what you're doing already and everyone is praising you for it, it would be exceptionally hard to throw that away and pursue something you could fail at.

value="2"> Second, we need people to be honest with themselves about whether they are truly capable of taking on that much responsibility. I unfortunately am not. At times I've told myself that I was, but I was just fooling myself. The vibes of heroic responsibility are immaculate, but vibes can be so dazzling that they prevent us from seeing reality. Countless people want to be a rockstar or a famous athlete or a billionaire, but only in the abstract. If they knew how much work and sacrifice were involved, they'd probably realise that they don't actually want that at all. Trying to take on too much responsibility will simply crush you, and you may take others down alongside you.

value="3"> Third, we need more training programs that hope for at least some proportion of their graduates to take up heroic responsibility. Maybe there should be some programs that only focus on this, but this risks pushing people to pick up a boulder heavier than they can carry, so I'd honestly think very carefully before pursuing something like this.

value="4"> Fourth, we need people to be strategic. It's very easy to fall into the trap of going “well, it's not much but it's something. Anyway, I just have limited capacity, I'm just building a block” when they probably had options that The article so far has discussed about the difficulties of building on others' work and how to avoid that. The article so far has discussed about the difficulties of building on others' work and how to avoid that. The article so far has discussed about the difficulties of building on others' work and how to avoid that.

}

{

# How the relative size modifier interacts with stack views

Ole Begemann

And what it can teach us about SwiftUI's stack layout algorithm

I have one more thing to say on the relative sizing view modifier from my previous post, Working with percentages in SwiftUI layout . I'm assuming you've read that article. The following is good to know if you want to use the modifier in your own code, but I hope you'll also learn some general tidbits about SwiftUI's layout algorithm for HStacks and VStacks.

id="using-relative-sizing-inside-a-stack-view">Using relative sizing inside a stack view

Let's apply the relativeProposed modifier to one of the subviews of an HStack :

```
class="highlight"> HStack ( spacing : 10 ) { Color . blue .
relativeProposed ( width : 0.5 ) Color . green Color . yellow } .
border ( . primary ) . frame ( height : 80 )
```

What do you expect to happen here? Will the blue view take up 50 % of the available width? The answer is no. In fact, the blue rectangle becomes narrower than the others:

This is because the HStack only proposes a proportion of its available width to each of its children. Here, the stack proposes one third of the available space to its first child, the relative sizing modifier. The modifier then halves this value, resulting in one sixth of the total width (minus spacing) for the blue color. The other two rectangles then become wider than one third because the first child view didn't use up its full proposed width.

Update May 1, 2024: SwiftUI's built-in containerRelativeFrame modifier (introduced after I wrote my modifier) doesn't exhibit this behavior because it uses the size of the nearest container view as its reference, and stack views don't count as containers in this context (which I find somewhat unintuitive, but that's the way it is).

id="order-matters">Order matters

Now let's move the modifier to the green color in the middle:

Naively, I'd expect an equivalent result: the green rectangle should become 100 pt wide, and blue and yellow should be 250 pt each. But that's not what happens — the yellow view ends up being wider than the blue one:

I found this unintuitive at first, but it makes sense if you understand that the HStack processes its children in sequence:

The HStack proposes one third of its available space to the blue view:  $(620 - 20) / 3 = 200$  . The blue view accepts the proposal and becomes 200 pt wide.

Next up is the relativeProposed modifier. The HStack divides the remaining space by the number of remaining subviews and proposes that:  $400 / 2 = 200$  . Our modifier halves this proposal and proposes 100 pt to the green view, which accepts it. The modifier in turn adopts the size of its child and returns 100 pt to the HStack.

Since the second subview used less space than proposed, the HStack now has 300 pt left over to propose to its final child, the yellow color.

Important: the order in which the stack lays out its subviews happens to be from left to right in this example, but that's not always the case. In general, HStacks and VStacks first group their subviews by layout priority (more on that below), and then order the views inside each group by flexibility such that the least flexible views are laid out first. For more on this, see How an HStack Lays out Its Children by Chris Eidhof. The views in our example are all equally flexible (they all can become any width between 0 and infinity), so the stack processes them in their "natural" order.

id="leftover-space-isnt-redistributed">Leftover space isn't redistributed

By now you may be able guess how the layout turns out when we move our view modifier to the last child view:

Blue and green each receive one third of the available width and become 200 pt wide. No surprises there.

When the HStack reaches the relativeProposed modifier, it has 200 pt left to distribute. Again, the modifier and the yellow rectangle only use half of this amount.

The end result is that the HStack ends up with 100 pt left over. The process stops here — the HStack does not start over in an attempt to find a "better" solution. The stack makes itself just big enough to contain its subviews (= 520 pt incl. spacing) and reports that size to its parent.

id="layout-priority">Layout priority

We can use the layoutPriority view modifier to influence how stacks and other containers lay out their children. Let's give the subview with the relative sizing modifier a higher layout priority (the default priority is 0):

This results in a layout where the yellow rectangle actually takes up 50 % of the available space:

Explanation:

The HStack groups its children by layout priority and then processes each group in sequence, from highest to lowest priority. Each group is proposed the entire remaining space.

The first layout group only contains a single view, our relative sizing modifier with the yellow color. The HStack proposes the entire available space (minus spacing) = 600 pt. Our modifier halves the proposal, resulting in 300 pt for



}

{

# Experimenting with Live Activities

Ole Begemann

iOS 16 beta 4 is the first SDK release that supports Live Activities. A Live Activity is a widget-like view an app can place on your lock screen and update in real time. Examples where this can be useful include live sports scores or train departure times.

These are my notes on playing with the API and implementing my first Live Activity.

`id="a-bike-computer-on-your-lock-screen">`A bike computer on your lock screen

My Live Activity is a display for a bike computer that I've been developing with a group of friends. Here's a video of it in action:

And here with simulated data:

I haven't talked much about our bike computer project publicly yet; that will hopefully change someday. In short, a group of friends and I designed a little box that connects to your bike's hub dynamo, measures speed and distance, and sends the data via Bluetooth to an iOS app. The app records all your rides and can also act as a live speedometer when mounted on your bike's handlebar. It's this last feature that I wanted to replicate in the Live Activity.

`id="follow-apples-guide">`Follow Apple's guide

Adding a Live Activity to the app wasn't hard. I found Apple's guide [Displaying live data on the Lock Screen with Live Activities](#) easy to follow and quite comprehensive.

`id="no-explicit-user-approval">`No explicit user approval

iOS doesn't ask the user for approval when an app wants to show a Live Activity. I found this odd since it seems to invite developers to abuse the feature, but maybe it's OK because of the foreground requirement (see below). Plus, users can disallow Live Activities on a per-app basis in Settings.

Users can dismiss an active Live Activity from the lock screen by swiping (like a notification).

Most apps will probably need to ask the user for notification permissions to update their Live Activities.

`id="the-app-must-be-in-the-foreground-to-start-an-activity">`The app must be in the foreground to start an activity

To start a Live Activity, an app must be open in the foreground. This isn't ideal for the bike computer because the speedometer can't appear magically on the lock screen when the user starts riding (even though iOS wakes up the app in the background at this point to deliver the Bluetooth events from the bike). The user has to open the app manually at least once.

On the other hand, this limitation may not be an issue for most use cases and will probably cut down on spamming/abuse significantly.

---

*However, the system performs some animation when the dynamic content of the Live Activity changes.*

---

Ole Begemann

`id="the-app-must-keep-running-in-the-background-to-update-the-activity-or-use-push-notifications">`The app must keep running in the background to update the activity (or use push notifications)

As long as the app keeps running (in the foreground or background), it can update the Live Activity as often as it wants (I think). This is ideal for the bike computer as the app keeps running in the background processing Bluetooth events while the bike is in motion. I assume the same applies to other apps that can remain alive in the background, such as audio players or navigation apps doing continuous location monitoring.

Updating the Live Activity once per second was no problem in my testing, and I didn't experience any rate limiting.

Most apps get suspended in the background, however. They must use push notifications to update their Live Activity (or background tasks or some other mechanism to have the system wake you up). Apple introduced a new kind of push notification that is delivered directly to the Live Activity, bypassing the app altogether. I haven't played with push notification updates, so I don't know the benefits of using this method over sending a silent push notification to wake the app and updating the Live Activity from there. Probably less aggressive rate limiting?

`id="lock-screen-color-matching">`Lock screen color matching

I haven't found a good way to match my Live Activity's colors to the current system colors on the lock screen. By default, text in a Live Activity is black in light mode, whereas the built-in lock screen themes seem to favor white or other light text colors. If there is an API or environment value that allows apps to match the color style of the current lock screen, I haven't found it. I experimented with various foreground styles, such as materials, without success.

I ended up hardcoding the foreground color, but I'm not satisfied with the result. Depending on the user's lock screen theme, the Live Activity can look out of place.

`id="animations-cant-be-disabled">`Animations can't be disabled

Apple's guide clearly states that developers have little control over animations in a Live Activity:

Animate content updates

}

{

# The One Thousand Blobcows Born Each Year

Morgan Day · The Paris Review Blog

A spotted creature is rolled across gravel. Another is placed on a dinner plate, then cradled in two palms. These were meant to be cows but emerged instead as balls of tissue and organs enclosed in hair coats. Their name, amorphous globosus, derives from the Greek and Latin for “formless sphere.” I watch videos of formless spheres for the same reason that I watch videos of miniature horses: I am in search of purity.

Amorphous globosus is a nonviable creature, incapable of development or growth. It’s more easily understood by its missing parts: a head and limbs, a mouth and genitals. Occasionally, it’s given a useless heart. It’s continuous; a sphere at infinity with the weight of a water bottle. Within it are more ineffectual formless spheres, fluid-filled cysts in lieu of functioning organs. At a threshold of never having lived yet never having not, amorphous globosus is hard to categorize. Neither a tumor nor fetus, it’s relegated to an anomaly: a fetal monster. Amorphous globosus is often buried in the dirt like a dead animal.

Driving by a cattle ranch, I envision a herd of formless spheres. Low in pasture grass, their short hair ruffles in the wind. One hundred thousand calves are born every day. One in thirty-five thousand are born as formless spheres, about three per day, over one thousand per year. At this moment, last year’s one thousand formless spheres are decomposing. They are contributing to new grass, soon to be eaten by cows, bringing about new formless spheres.

Georges Bataille wrote that we call a thing formless in order to undermine it. Those given the designation, he claims, will get squashed, “like a spider or an earthworm.” But formless is a misnomer on arrival, and a formless sphere is an oxymoron. I think amorphous globosus is an ideal form: animate yet inanimate, parasitic yet harmless, geological yet doughy, static yet reactive.

Even when all its qualities have been listed, the formless sphere stokes confusion in people. They reach for comparisons: a meatball, an egg, lab-harvested meat, a very large cow nugget. Like me, they prefer looking at images online of the creature as hairy and whole, without the attached umbilicus, without the remnants of the cow. They give it a better name: blobcow.

Can it feel pain? they ask. Can we put it on life support? If we kick it, how far will it roll? And if we squish it, will it squeak? Blobcow retains all the presence of a being with all the use and uselessness of an aesthetic object. At times, blobcow exudes the joy of these objects. Carried through tall grass, it jiggles.

style=“text-align: center;”> \*\*\*

Samuel Beckett’s Murphy (Murphy, 1938) straps himself naked to a rocking chair and stares at an iridescent beam of light. Murphy’s mind is a hollow sphere, “hermetically

closed to the universe without.” Murphy is clairaudient. For him, thought forms are as dominant as physical forms. Like a dog, he endures sensory experiences beyond human perception.

*This blobcow state is a needed break from the experience of his anatomy, a soft round escape.*

Morgan Day

As a remedy, Murphy lies supine in a park. He claims to pause his heart. Fed up with breathing, he seeks a respiratory machine. In his rocking chair, Murphy rocks himself into a stupor. His pineal gland shrinks to nothing as he seesaws the chair to its limit. His body quiets; he frees his mind. This blobcow state is a needed break from the experience of his anatomy, a soft round escape. Not death but not life, an in-between. The cause of his pain—his keen awareness of the world—becomes the origin point for his ascension.

Repetitive actions multiply across Beckett’s novels. A man alternates sitting on every stool at a bar. Another carries a handful of stones that he takes turns sucking on. Murphy walks “round and round” the prison, the cathedral, the cross, the wreck. Loops help to cope with the cycle of humanity: “a well with two buckets ... one going down to be filled, the other coming up to be emptied.”

Following a tiff with his lover Celia, Murphy heads for the front door. She asks if he is leaving for good. If he were leaving for good, Murphy explains, he would take to his chair and not the door. After he leaves, Celia undresses and rocks in the chair. She is in her mind with Murphy, her parents, herself as a girl, as an infant, until “it was finished, the days and places and things and people ... she was lying down, she had no history.” Celia, too, accesses the fundamental and original, rocking at the center of an infinite formless sphere.

Murphy asks, “What was the etymology of gas?” and gives no answer. Historically, the etymology of gas dates back to the seventeenth-century belief that an occult principle exists in all matter. Within Murphy’s rocking chair lives a spirit. It is characterized by “superfine chaos,” secret knowledge, a void.

style=“text-align: center;”> \*\*\*

In Ambera Wellmann’s painting UnGodly (2021), an indefinable creature births a trinity of humanlike figures from its mouth. Or maybe it’s consuming them. There are few beginnings and no endings, or many beginnings mistaken for many endings, taking place in the erotic rupture in its face. Gazing nowhere yet everywhere, the seeming mammal, with an invertebrate tail, advances and recedes on a black (fore)(back)ground.

}

{

# All My Thoughts After 40 Hours in the Vision Pro

Tim Urban · Wait But Why

I'm writing this on a 30-foot screen on top of a 10,000-foot mountain in Hawaii, at a table in an Austin coffee shop where I'm pretty sure other people are taking photos of me to send to their friends so they can all call me a piece of shit. In the last week, life has gotten weird.

My journey to the Haleakalā shield volcano Austin coffee shop began more than 30 years ago, in 1990, when my parents brought me to something called a “virtual reality exhibit” at the Seaport World Trade Center in Boston. I stood on a little circular pedestal, and the guy handed me a plastic gun and put a big headset on me. Suddenly I was in some cartoon world, in a military uniform, holding a real gun. The person on the pedestal next to me was there, also a cartoon, also holding a gun. After some janky waving and shooting, they kicked me out for the next person in line.

I had recently read *The Phantom Tollbooth*, where a kid in the real world crosses a magic threshold and enters a cartoon world. This felt like that. I wanted more.

Then VR disappeared for 25 years. Throughout the '90s and 2000s, “virtual reality” was a forgotten dream—a cool concept that never made it. But in the mid-2010s, VR made an unexpected comeback. 20-year-old Palmer Luckey's duct-taped headset prototype had impressed enough investors for Oculus to become a real company. In 2014, Facebook bought Oculus. Google and Sony got involved. It was all finally happening.

In 2016, I decided to write about the VR revolution. I went around Silicon Valley, interviewing people at Google and Facebook to get the full scoop on VR. I even sat down with Mark Zuckerberg.

I demoed everything. It was mind-blowing. VR was about to take over the world. And I was gonna be the one to tell everyone.

Then two things happened:

VR didn't take over the world.

I didn't write a VR post because I fell into a six-year book hole instead.

From the bottom of my book hole, I kept following the story. At Facebook's 2016 developer conference, Zuckerberg had demoed a new bleeding-edge kind of “standalone, inside out” headset. Up until then, there were two ways to do VR: The first was with a cheap headset, maybe using your phone as a screen, that could do primitive head-movement tracking but had no way to see the environment around you. The second was with external sensors on the walls and a headset that attached to a high-powered PC with a cord. “Standalone” meant the new headset would have the computer inside, with no need for a cable. “Inside out” meant the headset could see the room around you, so you didn't

need external sensors. In 2016, this was just a prototype. Three years later, Facebook launched Oculus Quest.

In 2020, standing around during Covid with my dick in my hand like everyone else, I got myself a Quest 2. It was amazing. I loved it. It was my daily post-writing reward activity. I made 3D art . I swam with whales . I went on cartoon vacations . I exercised by slashing music . I beat *Trover* .

Then, for some reason, I stopped. I can't really explain why. I really loved being in the Quest 2. I recently dusted it off to give friends a demo and they were floored, reminding me how great it is. It just didn't hook me. Maybe it was the solo aspect. I don't have friends who do VR so there's no one else to play with. Maybe it's the friction. It's minor, but charging the headset, putting it on, and creating a boundary 1 is still a lot more friction than picking up my phone. Maybe my delight relied more on novelty than I realized.

It's not just me. VR blows everyone away when they try it, but it seems to have a hard time hooking people for the long run. After a major wave of hype in the mid-2010s, VR receded into the land of subcultures.

And the question is: Is there some fatal flaw to the concept of VR that will always prevent it from achieving mass adoption? Or are we some tipping point away from VR exploding into the stratosphere like the computer and smartphone?

Everyone remembers where they were when they learned that JFK was shot, a man had landed on the moon, or airplanes had flown into the Twin Towers. I remember where I was when I saw Steve Jobs unveil the first iPhone .

I didn't always like Apple. My family's first computer was an Apple 2GS. But then, like many early Apple computer users, I became a PC person. I used an IBM ThinkPad in college and thought Apple people were annoying.

Then Steve Jobs came back to Apple and started Making Apple Great Again. My post-college music composing path forced me to get a 2004 PowerBook G4. After getting used to the interface ( why the fuck is there no start button? ), I realized that Macs were amazing, and I've been an annoying Apple person ever since. But it wasn't until 2007 that I became a fanboy.

In the presentation, when Jobs did the world's first “swipe to unlock,” the audience made an audible gasp . A minute later, he brought up a list of artists in the phone's “iPod” app and asked , “Well, how do I scroll through my list of artists? I just take my finger and scroll.” Another audible gasp. It's weird that something so normal today was jaw-dropping 17 years ago.

The feeling I had watching that presentation had happened before. I felt it when I was five years old and tried Nintendo for the first time at a friend's house ( I can make something on the TV move by clicking this button?? ). I felt it in the early '90s when my friend showed me how to send an email ( You can type something on your computer, hit a button,

}

{

# Sagrado Corazón

Lina Ferreira Cabeza-Vanegas · *The Paris Review Blog*

I was fifteen in the year 2000. Turn of the millennium, turn of tables and tides. Every morning there were reports on the radio, and every night the news showed footage of the peace talks between the Colombian government and the FARC forces. Folding tables and plastic chairs in a room with no walls, and I don't think anyone really thought anything would come of it.

Still, we watched. The future of our country on the screen and on a precipice. History about to reassert itself or buckle under the demands of men in linen shirts and bootlegged fatigues. At 9 P. M. every night between 1999 and 2002, the cameras settled on sweat-stained shirts and stern faces to capture the exact moment when we would all be remade with the stroke of a pen and a handshake like fishermen in a Bible verse. Microphones, dress shoes, and rifles. What'll happen next? we asked. Stay tuned, they said.

On Sunday night, May 14, it was the same. What will happen next? We'll have to see. I washed my shoelaces in the bathroom sink for Monday school-uniform inspection before morning Mass, while three hours north of Bogotá, a man carefully packed explosives into a PVC pipe frame, like a hermit crab slides a soft body into a borrowed shell.

style="text-align: center;">\*\*\*

My mother went to school with nuns; my father went to school with priests. So, when it came time to enroll their daughters, they searched high and low for the furthest thing from a Catholic education that Bogotá had to offer.

Not an easy task.

In 1902, the poet-president, José Manuel Marroquín, in an effort to heal the wounds left by the War of a Thousand Days, consecrated Colombia to the Sacred Heart of Jesus. And though the solemn consecration was effectively voided by the revised constitution in 1991—to prevent religious discrimination—no one seemed to notice, or care. In 2008, the Catholic Church renewed the consecration, and once more made Colombia officially “el país del Sagrado Corazón de Jesús.”

The options were few and strange, but eventually my parents settled for a Montessori-style school founded by a former nun, located far out in the countryside beside a small eucalyptus forest and a canal flowing slowly with sewage and green rot.

So, at the age of five, every morning, along with my elder sister, in our uniforms and wool ruanas, we stepped into thick Andean mist. We navigated by memory through the walled-in collection of houses where we lived, as if walking through clouds of milk steam, as if through the blurry corners of end-of-the-world maps. Most days the fog had cleared by the time we joined the huddle of bloodshot-eyed children, yawning and gripping lunch boxes, though

sometimes it never seemed to lift at all. Nearby, a guard with a loaded shotgun sipped coffee from his thermos while waiting for cars and vans to take us to schools scattered across the city.

I remember brown birds bathing in the gutter, stray dogs barking in the distance, and the voice of morning radio hosts rising from the guard's portable AM radio. Fútbol scores, daily bombings, chatter about that Sofía Vergara —“Did you see her? Barely seventeen and nearly naked in that Pepsi commercial, all of Latin America is gonna see it too? They'll know soon how beautiful Colombian women are”—and the latest news about Lucho Herrera's race. “La Vuelta a España, il Giro d'Italia, le Tour de France. ¡Ahí va nuestro Lucho! Our Lucho. Go, Lucho, go!” Until finally, a sheet-metal Renault 4 that rumbled like stagehand thunder cut through the fog with blinding high beams, and we were told, “Hurry up, get in, let's go!”

style="text-align: center;">\*\*\*

We don't know much about this man and this night. A few facts only:

Around four in the morning he, along with at least two others, walked through the front door of a home called Hope, in an area known as Sanctuary, on a street named Palestine. La Esperanza, El Santuario, La Palestina. One that Ana Elvia Cortés Gil shared with her husband, Salomón Pachón.

The men wore ski masks and military fatigues, and they wanted money.

There is disagreement about nearly every other detail in the reports.

Sometimes the men arrived at three in the morning, sometimes at four. Sometimes there were three of them, and sometimes more. Always, though, it ended with a single woman with a single bomb strapped around her neck.

Was there a knock, a whistle? A hand sliding back the curtains, and then sliding back locks so the rest could slither into the house like mustard fog and black mist, so they could place their hands on sleeping bodies like orderlies, like exorcists, like rubber-gloved men on slabs of live-wire eels?

Was the bomb zipped into an old-school backpack? A hit man's duffel bag? Wrapped in newspaper and bubble wrap, tied up with old shoelaces and string? Placed carefully into a plastic grocery-store bag and held carefully in both arms like a sleeping baby, like an egg on a spoon, like a bowl of water filled to the brim? Like a ticking bomb?

Perhaps they put the bomb down gently beside a potted plant, and they kicked down a flimsy wood-panel door that went flying in splinters, wood chips, and loose hinges. The sole of a boot, the crack of a door, and the sound of men yelling, “Malparidos, hijueputas, ahora sí que sí!” Wake up, motherfuckers, now you'll see what's what!



}

{

# Where View.task gets its main-actor isolation from

Ole Begemann

SwiftUI's `.task` modifier inherits its actor context from the surrounding function. If you call `.task` inside a view's body property, the async operation will run on the main actor because `View.body` is (semi-secretly) annotated with `@MainActor`. However, if you call `.task` from a helper property or function that isn't `@MainActor`-annotated, the async operation will run in the cooperative thread pool.

id="example">Example

Here's an example. Notice the two `.task` modifiers in `body` and `helperView`. The code is identical in both, yet only one of them compiles — in `helperView`, the call to a main-actor-isolated function fails because we're not on the main actor in that context:

```
@MainActor func onMainActor () { print ( "on MainActor" ) }

struct ContentView : View { var body : some View { VStack
{ helperView Text ( "in body" ) . task { /\ We can call a
@MainActor func without await onMainActor () } } }

var helperView : some View { Text ( "in helperView" ) . task
{ /\ ❌❌ Error: Expression is 'async' but is not marked with
'await' onMainActor () } } }
```

id="why-does-it-work-like-this">Why does it work like this?

This behavior is caused by two (semi-)hidden annotations in the SwiftUI framework:

The `View` protocol annotates its `body` property with `@MainActor`. This transfers to all conforming types.

`View.task` annotates its `action` parameter with `@_inheritActorContext`, causing it to adopt the actor context from its use site.

Sadly, none of these annotations are visible in the SwiftUI documentation, making it very difficult to understand what's going on. The `@MainActor` annotation on `View.body` is present in Xcode's generated Swift interface for SwiftUI (Jump to Definition of `View`), but that feature doesn't work reliably for me, and as we'll see, it doesn't show the whole truth, either.

id="swiftuis-module-interface">SwiftUI's module interface

To really see the declarations the compiler sees, we need to look at SwiftUI's module interface file. A module interface is like a header file for Swift modules. It lists the module's public declarations and even the implementations of inlinable functions. Module interfaces use normal Swift syntax and have the `.swiftinterface` file extension.

SwiftUI's module interface is located at:

(There can be multiple `.swiftinterface` files in that directory, one per CPU architecture. Pick any one of them. Pro tip for viewing the file in Xcode: Editor > Syntax Coloring > Swift enables syntax highlighting.)

Inside, you'll find that `View.body` has the `@MainActor(unsafe)` attribute:

```
class="highlight"> @available ( iOS 13.0 , macOS 10.15 , tvOS
13.0 , watchOS 6.0 , * ) @_typeEraser ( AnyView ) public pro-
tocol View { /\ ... @SwiftUI . ViewBuilder @Concurrency .
MainActor ( unsafe ) var body : Self . Body { get } }
```

And you'll find this declaration for `.task`, including the `@_inheritActorContext` attribute:

```
class="highlight"> @available ( iOS 15.0 , macOS 12.0 ,
tvOS 15.0 , watchOS 8.0 , * ) extension SwiftUI . View
{ #if compiler(>=5.3) && $AsyncAwait && $Sendable &&
$InheritActorContext @inlinable public func task ( pri-
ority : _Concurrency . TaskPriority = . userInitiated ,
@_inheritActorContext _ action : @escaping @Sendable ()
async -> Swift . Void ) -> some SwiftUI . View { modifier
( _TaskModifier ( priority : priority , action : action ) ) }
#endif /\ ... }
```

id="putting-it-all-together">Putting it all together

Armed with this knowledge, everything makes more sense:

When used inside `body`, `task` inherits the `@MainActor` context from `body`.

When used outside of `body`, there is no implicit `@MainActor` annotation, so `task` will run its operation on the cooperative thread pool by default.

Unless the view contains an `@ObservedObject` or `@StateObject` property, which makes the entire view `@MainActor` via this obscure rule for property wrappers whose wrapped-Value property is bound to a global actor:

A struct or class containing a wrapped instance property with a global actor-qualified `wrappedValue` infers actor isolation from that property wrapper

Update May 1, 2024: SE-0401: Remove Actor Isolation Inference caused by Property Wrappers removes the above rule when compiling in Swift 6 language mode. This is a good change because it makes reasoning about actor isolation simpler. In the Swift 5 language mode, you can opt into the better behavior with the `-enable-upcoming-feature DisableOutwardActorInference` compiler flags. I recommend you do.

The lesson: if you use helper properties or functions in your view, consider annotating them with `@MainActor` to get the same semantics as `body`.

By the way, note that the actor context only applies to code that is placed directly inside the `async` closure, as well as to synchronous functions the closure calls. Async functions

}

standard-article( title: [Jason Biggs Directorial Debut UNTITLED HOME INVASION ROMANCE Now Available!], author: [McEric], source-name: [Ain't It Cool News], images: (), paragraphs: ( [Jason Biggs Directorial Debut UNTITLED HOME INVASION ROMANCE Now Available! Comedy/Thrillers stars Biggs and Meaghan Rath.], [Read the full article on AICN], [Jason Biggs, aka Jim from AMERICAN PIE, is behind the camera this year with the comedy-thriller UNTITLED HOME INVASION ROMANCE. I've talked to plenty of actors-turned-directors and most of them dip their toes in with a smaller project before going into a full feature; a music video, an episode of television, a short film, etc. Not Biggs. He dove straight in. I admire that.], [Not veering too far from his wheelhouse, UNTITLED HOME INVASION ROMANCE is a thriller second and a comedy first. Biggs plays Kevin, a lovelorn loser you could easily mistake for Jim, who has been separated from his wife Suzie, played by Meaghan Rath, for a few weeks following an impasse. Eager to prove himself a manly man capable of protecting her through all of life's foibles, he arranges a romantic getaway at her father's summer rental cabin... with a twist. He's convinced a buddy from his acting class to arrive at the home, "break in," and threaten the couple so that Kevin can puff his chest out and chase the "assailant" away. As is typically the case with these sorts of schemes, things go awry, and soon bodies start dropping.], [UNTITLED HOME INVASION ROMANCE comes across as light and slapsticky, despite its fairly steep body count and frequent disregard for its victims. It's genuinely funny at times while unnecessarily cruel at others, which creates a unique tone for the first-time director. Meaghan Rath is a welcome surprise as Suzie, a self-assured success with a lurking darkness within her], [Finish the article on AICN], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 279, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Harry loves FANTASTIC FOUR FIRST STEPS, but has notes...], author: [headgeek], source-name: [Ain't It Cool News], images: (), paragraphs: ( [Great wonderful Marvel film], [Read the full article on AICN], [Hey folks, Harry here... Been a while since I last was here. Life has been good, directed a version of Hitchcock's THE 39 STEPS for stage successfully, and well... Took the family to check out the new FANTASTIC FOUR: FIRST STEPS.], [Now that was a spectacular film. We drove to Lawton, Oklahoma to check it out at the Patriot IMAX theater there. The Handicap seating was about 5 rows up from the bottom of the auditorium, which had us beholding an immense screen that filled our entire field of vision. Now, going into this flick, I understood a lot of what I'd be seeing. I knew it was taking place in the so-called Jack Kirby universe of 828, based upon Kirby's birthday. However, I also understood that what we were going to see was really a loving tribute to the 1960's and 70's Science Fiction universe. Having seen Matt Shankman say the words "Kubrick meets Kirby"], [KUBRICK MEETS KIRBY regarding a FANTASTIC FOUR movie is a bold glove to throw down. It makes one seriously contemplate Kubrick meets Kirby, which actually happened with Jack Kirby adapted 2001: A SPACE ODYSSEY in a truly mind-blowing comic book adaptation. Seek it out! But while

standard-article( title: [Advanced Swift, fifth edition], author: [Ole Begemann], source-name: [Ole Begemann], images: (), paragraphs: ( [We released the fifth edition of our book Advanced Swift a few days ago. You can buy the ebook on the objc.io site . The hardcover print edition is printed and sold by Amazon ( amazon.com , amazon.co.uk , amazon.de ).], [Highlights of the new edition:], [Fully updated for Swift 5.6], [A new Concurrency chapter covering async/await, structured concurrency, and actors], [New content on property wrappers, result builders, protocols, and generics], [The print edition is now a hardcover (for the same price)], [Free update for owners of the ebook], [id="a-growing-book-for-a-growing-language">A growing book for a growing language], [Updating the book always turns out to be more work than I expect. Swift has grown substantially since our last release (for Swift 5.0), and the size of the book reflects this. The fifth edition is 76 % longer than the first edition from 2016. This time, we barely stayed under 1 million characters:], [Many thanks to our editor, Natalye , for reading all this and improving our Dutch/German dialect of English.], [id="hardcover">Hardcover], [For the first time, the print edition comes in hardcover (for the same price). Being able to offer this makes me very happy. The hardcover book looks much better and is more likely to stay open when laid flat on a table.], [We also increased the page size from 15×23 cm (6×9 in) to 18×25 cm (7×10 in) to keep the page count manageable (Amazon's print on demand service limits hardcover books to 550 pages).], [I hope you enjoy the new edition. If you decide to buy the book or if you bought it in the past, thank you very much! And if you're willing to write a review on Amazon , we'd appreciate it.], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 295, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Ina Garten Brings In Intimacy Coordinator For Shot With Fresh Lemon Tart], author: [The Onion Staff], source-name: [The Onion], images: (), paragraphs: ( [EAST HAMPTON, NY—In an effort to maintain a safe and respectful environment on set, Food Network host Ina Garten reportedly brought in an intimacy coordinator Friday to supervise a shot with a fresh lemon tart. "Where should I put my hands?" said the 78-year-old Garten, who emphasized the importance of keeping everything professional with carefully staged choreography between herself and the shortbread pastry. "Okay, I'll stay on this side of the parchment paper, and it can stay on that side. And can we do a few rehearsals so we can both get used to exactly what I'm doing with my mouth? I want it so I can really be in the moment when we start rolling. I apologize in advance if my moans are too loud." At press time, sources reported that Garten had called for a closed set in order to film a scene with a juicy spatchcocked chicken.], [The post Ina Garten Brings In Intimacy Coordinator For Shot With Fresh Lemon Tart appeared first on The Onion .], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 170, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

the film is an absolute blast, that I truly love... I wish it truly would've honored Jack Kirby by delving even deeper into his imagination with the FANTASTIC FOUR., [I've had friends and my wife gripe to me about Sue Storm's overpowering of], [Finish the article on AICN], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 260, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

---

*Now, going into this flick, I understood a lot of what I'd be seeing.*

headgeek

---

standard-article( title: [NASA To Build \$20 Billion Moon Base], author: [The Onion Staff], source-name: [The Onion], images: (), paragraphs: ( [NASA will repurpose components from a scrapped space station to construct a \$20 billion base on the moon's surface over the next seven years, opting to focus on infrastructure that supports sustained operations on the lunar surface. What do you think?], [Irena McGrath, Resource Funneler], [Tristan Winslet, Wiring Expert], [Owen Blair, Microwave Optimizer], [The post NASA To Build \$20 Billion Moon Base appeared first on The Onion .], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 200, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

---

standard-article( title: [Episode 916: The Council of Trent? Hello?], author: [Matthew Wrather], source-name: [Overthinking It], images: (), paragraphs: ( [style="text-align: center;"]> Support Overthinking It by becoming a member for \$5/month!, [Pete Fenzel, Mark Lee, and Matt Wrather overthink Wake Up Dead Man: A Knives Out Mystery , the latest installment in the Benoit Blanc Cinematic Murder Universe. The panelists appreciated the rich, cinematic presentation of the movie, especially compared to most made-for-Netflix movies, but they also took issue with how the film treats Catholicism more as symbolic wallpaper than as a lived, institutional reality. Where are the baptisms? The first communions? The immigrants? Most importantly, why is everyone so concerned about finding a lost diamond when it would've been a lot easier to embezzle the Sunday collection money?], [Those critiques aside, everyone appreciated the portrayal of Father Jud as an authentic moral center for the story and as a thematic counterbalance to Benoit Blanc's cold rationalism. It makes for a very different Knives Out movie compared to its predecessors; whether it's better or worse than those is largely a matter of taste and perspective. But it's beyond argument that Daniel Craig's accent remains sublime through them all.], [Download (MP3)], [Watch Wake Up Dead Man: A Knives Out Mystery on Netflix], [The Sacred Heart of Jesus], [The Council of Trent], [style="margin: 5px 0; padding: 10px; background: #eee;"]>, [style="margin: 0; padding: 0;"]> Episode 916: The Council of Trent? Hello? originally appeared on Overthinking It , the site subjecting the popular culture to a level of scrutiny it probably doesn't deserve. [ Latest Posts | Podcast ( iTunes Link )]], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 260, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

---

*But it's beyond argument that Daniel Craig's accent remains sublime through them all.*

Matthew Wrather

---

standard-article( title: [We Interview Josh Duhamel and Michael Socha for PRESCHOOL], author: [McEric], source-name: [Ain't It Cool News], images: (), paragraphs: ( [We interview Josh Duhamel (pulling double duty as actor and director) and Michael Socha about their new comedy, PRESCHOOL.], [Read the full article on AICN], [Parenting is Hell, and when we look to our children to absolve our sins or try to live vicariously through them, it's even worse. That's the premise behind PRESCHOOL, the new PG-13 comedy from writer Richard D'Ovidio (HYPNOTIC, THIR13EEN GHOSTS) and director Josh Duhamel (BUDDY GAMES).],

---

standard-article( title: [Ancient Scroll Reveals Lost Miracle Of Christ Correctly Guessing People's Weights], author: [The Onion Staff], source-name: [The Onion], images: (), paragraphs: ( [JERUSALEM—Historians confirmed Friday that a recent archaeological find in the Judean Hills is an authentic early Christian scroll, one that depicts the previously unknown miracle of Jesus Christ correctly guessing people's weights just by looking at them. "The papyrus is remarkably well-preserved, with an unbroken Aramaic script that describes Christ strolling through Galilee with a serene smile, calling out, 'Come forth, all ye people, but for a single

[Duhamel (TRANSFORMERS, SHOTGUN WEDDING) stars as Alan, an American expatriate who's married into affluence while Michael Socha ("Being Human," THIS IS ENGLAND) plays Brian, a bootstrapping entrepreneur who's built his fortune through determination and risk. The film opens with each father greeting their newborns in separate hospitals, promising them the best that life has to offer and swearing their fealty to the next generation. Brian seems the more pragmatic of the two, laying out the blueprint for success to a minutes-old empty vessel that hasn't the agency to accept while Alan encourages his growing progeny to be an astronaut (likely in a throwback to American superiority in that field).], [When both fathers end up at the prestigious Puggsley Academy (a name I'm sure is meant to illustrate the folly of antiquity) and learn there is only one open slot left, their oaths to their children ignite the competitiveness within them and the war commences. Through dinners, sporting outings, and a little light stalking, the men learn each other's weaknesses and plot to exploit them to achieve their ends.], [The film constantly toys with the audience's allegiance to either father, painting each in hues of sincerity and villainy. Brian seems to be the more sincere of the two], [Finish the article on AICN], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 283, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Episode 915: This is MY House. MY HOUSE.], author: [Matthew Wrather], source-name: [Overthinking It], images: (), paragraphs: ( [style="text-align: center;"]> Support Overthinking It by becoming a member for \$5/month!, [Peter Fenzel and Matthew Wrather return to Downton Abbey (thrumming music and all), for what may be the last time. This show has been an exceptionally deep well for us over the years and this film is not no exception. It's a little thin, honestly, but it knows the assignment and it has its charms, including the spectacle of Lady Mary cast out from polite society, Robert visibly flustered when he sees a showgirl, Edith finally bringing some main character energy, and Mrs. Patmore asking Mrs. Hughes-Carson about boning.], [This is a film about what becomes of the children (do they get a prize at the fair?), and how we hand off our patrimony from one generation to the next; it's only fitting that it has not one but three Fenzelian Downton Abbey Moments®. Matt and Pete go into them in detail, even though Matt is a little disappointed that the packed plot doesn't leave enough room for each event to breathe.], [If you've ever had a fight with a family member at a real estate viewing, you'll be delighted by the supremely relatable Crawley family and their (now multi-generational!) foibles.], [Download (MP3)], [The long history of Downton Abbey on Overthinking It], [style="margin: 5px 0; padding: 10px; background: #eee;"]>, [style="margin: 0; padding: 0;"]> Episode 915: This is MY House. MY HOUSE. originally appeared on Overthinking It , the site subjecting the popular culture to a level of scrutiny it probably doesn't deserve. [ Latest Posts | Podcast ( iTunes Link )]], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 264, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

coin of silver,' before closing His eyes and naming a weight that was always accurate within a few shekels," said biblical scholar Harris Solomon, noting that the scroll depicts a clay jar of small prizes kept beside Christ at all times to be handed out to anyone whose weight He guessed wrong, something that, according to the text, never occurred. "This scroll completely upends our traditional image of Jesus, as the text describes Him not in simple robes and a beard but in a pinstripe tunic with a waxed mustache. Yet Christ's generosity is still evident, as one passage recounts Him performing His miracle for an emaciated leper free of charge. The verse reads, 'And lo, He lifted His hand and spake: The leper's weight is one talent, 19 minas, and 13 shekels. And they were sore amazed, for it was true unto the very last measure.'" The newly unearthed scroll also reveals that in quieter moments, Christ would cover Himself in silver dust and stand motionless on a box on the side of a busy Nazareth street, miraculously transforming Himself into a statue for hours on end.], [The post Ancient Scroll Reveals Lost Miracle Of Christ Correctly Guessing People's Weights appeared first on The Onion .], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 275, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Troy Duffy Talks THE BOONDOCK SAINTS - Past, Present, and Future], author: [McEric], source-name: [Ain't It Cool News], images: (), paragraphs: ( [Writer/Director Troy Duffy (THE BOONDOCK SAINTS) discusses his new prequel novel BLOOD ORIGIN, the enduring fans of THE BOONDOCK SAINTS, and those rumors surrounding a possible new entry in the series.], [Read the full article on AICN], [I'm sure I don't need to offer an introduction to THE BOONDOCK SAINTS, but just in case, here it is:], [Back in the late 1900s, a bouncer at a bar in L. A. wrote a hard-boiled crime thriller that ignited a bidding war in Hollywood. The resultant film, THE BOONDOCK SAINTS, released in mid-1999, was a cultural milestone. Critics thrashed it and, honestly, they can't be blamed. The film is misogynistic, racist, and glorifies violence. Actually, "glorifies" isn't a strong enough word. THE BOONDOCK SAINTS treats violence like it's the best thing since sliced arteries... er, bread.], [But the critics, ultimately, didn't write the story of the film's success; that was left to the fans. The film's release was quiet, but word-of-mouth made the cacophony surrounding the film rise to deafening levels. (I, personally, might never have found the film if I hadn't been working in a video store at the time, shelving the admittedly fetching VHS sleeve.) THE BOONDOCK SAINTS became a massive cult hit. Many identified with the film's themes of fraternal bonds, justice, morality, loyalty, and vigilante revenge fantasy. It's a perfect time capsule of the late-90's crime caper movie: it's funny, irreverent, brash, profane, stylish, bloody, and oddly uplifting. More than anything, though, it's just fucking cool.], [The film centers around the MacManus Brothers, Connor (Sean Patrick Flanery) and Murphy (Norman Reedus), working-class Irish immigrants in Boston who run afoul of the Russian and Italian Mafia. No shrinking wallflowers, these capable fighters with an iron-clad Irish Catholic code of morality], [Finish the article on

standard-article( title: [Swift Evolution proposals in Alfred], author: [Ole Begemann], source-name: [Ole Begemann], images: (), paragraphs: ( [I rarely participate actively in the Swift Evolution process, but I frequently refer to evolution proposals for my work, often multiple times per week. The proposals aren't always easy to read, but they're the most comprehensive (and sometimes only) documentation we have for many Swift features.], [For years, my tool of choice for searching Swift Evolution proposals has been Karoy Lorentey's swift-evolution workflow for Alfred .], [The workflow broke recently due to data format changes. Karoy was kind enough to add me as a maintainer so I could fix it.], [The new version 2.1.0 is now available on GitHub . Download the .alfredworkflow file and double-click to install. Besides the fix, the update has a few other improvements:], [The proposal title is now displayed more prominently.], [New actions to copy the proposal title (hold down Command ) or copy it as a Markdown link (hold down Shift + Command ).], [The script forwards the main meta-data of the selected proposal (id, title, status, URL) to Alfred. If you want to extend the workflow with your own actions, you can refer to these variables.], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 184, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

AICN], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 295, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [A Conversation with RENTAL FAMILY Writer/Director HIKARI], author: [McEric], source-name: [Ain't It Cool News], images: (), paragraphs: ( [McEric chats with RENTAL FAMILY writer/director HIKARI.], [Read the full article on AICN], [HIKARI's RENTAL FAMILY is the feel-good charmer that everyone needs around Thanksgiving, a gentle reminder that family is organic, genuine, and irreplaceable. Even when we sometimes wish we could rent an understudy to fill our place.], [RENTAL FAMILY stars Brendan Fraser as Phillip, an American actor living alone in Japan for the past seven years, struggling to find consistent work. Think LOST IN TRANSLATION, only don't, because this film provides a much deeper portrait of Japan than Sofia Coppola's Oscar-winner. LOST IN TRANSLATION, though a beautiful portrait of loneliness, uses Japan as a superficial location, giving us the eyes of a visitor through which to take in its beauty. RENTAL FAMILY has an expatriate at its center but Phillip has taken swimmingly to his new home. He's fluent, versed in the customs, and permanent. One never gets the idea that Phillip is working towards returning "home" - he is home. With him as our anchor, we feel like we belong, seeing past the tourist attractions to find the core of community.], [Phillip is auditioning steadily, getting bit roles here and there, but he needs something with longevity. He stumbles into Rental Family, a service that sells "memories." Mastermind Tada (Takehiro Hira) is introduced as a compassionate man with a fierce streak of pragmatism, which is aided by his right hand and lead actress Aiko (Mari Yamamoto). Brought on board as their "token white guy," Phillip finds himself acting as a groom, a best friend, a karaoke champion, a journalist, and a long-lost], [Finish the article on AICN], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 270, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

---

### *He's fluent, versed in the customs, and permanent.*

McEric

standard-article( title: [Pattern matching on error codes], author: [Ole Begemann], source-name: [Ole Begemann], images: (), paragraphs: ( [Foundation overloads the pattern matching operator = to enable matching against error codes in catch clauses.], [catch clauses in Swift support pattern matching, using the same patterns you'd use in a case clause inside a switch or in an if case ... statement. For example, to handle a file-not-found error you might write:], [do { let fileURL = URL ( filePath : "/abc" ) /\ non-existent file let data = try Data ( contentsOf : fileURL ) } catch let error as CocoaError where error . code == . fileReadNoSuchFile { print ( "File doesn't exist" ) } catch { print ( "Other error: \( error ) " ) }], [This binds a value of type CocoaError to the variable error and then uses a where clause to check the specific error code.], [However, if you don't need access to the complete error instance, there's a shorter way to write this, matching directly against the error code:], [id="foundation-overloads">Foundation overloads =], [I was wondering why this shorter syntax works. Is there some special compiler magic for pattern matching against error

standard-article( title: [LONDON CALLING Interviews - Josh Duhamel & Jeremy Ray Taylor], author: [McEric], source-name: [Ain't It Cool News], images: (), paragraphs: ( [McEric interviews stars Josh Duhamel and Jeremy Ray Taylor as well as writer/director Allan Ungar for the new action-comedy LONDON CALLING.], [Read the full article on AICN], [Josh Duhamel has reteamed with BANDIT director Allan Ungar for the new action-comedy LONDON CALLING. Ungar, retooling a script by Omer Levin Meneske and Quinn Wolfe, humanizes Duhamel's character and finds comedy in the absurdity of violence and perceptions of masculinity. "After fleeing from a job gone wrong, a down-on-his-luck hit man must babysit the son of a crime boss and show him how to become a man." Jeremy Ray Taylor of IT fame plays the son in question, Julian, whose father is played with acerbic and spiteful glee by Rick Hoffman. Rounding out the cast are big dogs Arnold Vosloo (THE MUMMY) and Aidan Gillen ("Game of Thrones").], [LONDON CALLING pulls off the rare hat trick of offering an action comedy that's actually funny. When we first meet Tommy Ward he is

codes of NSError instances? Turns out: no, the answer is much simpler. Foundation includes an overload for the pattern matching operator = that matches error values against error codes. 1], [The implementation looks something like this:], [class="highlight"> public func = ( code : CocoaError . Code , error : any Error ) -> Bool { guard let error = error as? CocoaError else { return false } return error . code == code }], [The actual code in Foundation is a little more complex because it goes through a hidden protocol named \_ErrorCodeProtocol , but that's not important. You can check out the code in the Foundation repository: Darwin version , swift-corelibs-foundation version .], [This matching on error codes is available for CocoaError , URLError , POSIXError , and MachError (and possibly more types in other Apple frameworks, I haven't checked).], [id="fn:1">], [I wrote about the = operator before, way back in 2015(!): Pattern matching in Swift and More pattern matching examples . ↵], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 374, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Kris Collins, Celina Myers, and Jason-Christopher Mayer Talk HOUSE ON EDEN], author: [McEric], source-name: [Ain't It Cool News], images: (), paragraphs: ( [McErick chats with Kris Collins (KallMeKris), Celina Myers (CelinaSpookyBoo), and Jason-Christopher Mayer about their new movie HOUSE ON EDEN in theaters July 25, 2025.], [Read the full article on AICN], [Found footage horror is a trope that is riddled with far more misses than hits. A few stand above the rest, but more often we get left with something like DEVON - an experiment in indulgence that leaves its viewers wondering what they might have done to deserve such a slap-in-the-face.], [As access to cameras and editing software has become more prevalent, more and more people are making content. Note I didn't say "films." Content creators are the new zeitgeist - a movement of User-Generated-Content that brings your friends and neighbors closer to your face while we all collapse deeper within ourselves. Some of these content creators are breaking the limitations of the phone screen and branching out to the cineplexes, to varying degrees of success.], [If you survived the Pandemic then you likely know who Kris Collins is. Perhaps not by name, but you've almost certainly seen one of her many characters come across your TikTok feed, YouTube Shorts, or Instagram Reels. Kris rose to fame through TikTok in 2020 with light comedy and relatability as KallMeKris. Like many content creators who rocketed to fame quickly, she began to mingle in creator-circles, forging a friendship with Celina Myers, aka CelinaSpookyBoo. Celina's content began as dad jokes, evolving into all manner of relatable antics and occasional cringe comedy. These two joined forces with Spooky AF Productions, a legitimate ghost hunting channel along with creators Sam and Colby.], [Eventually the idea came to make a film based on these ghost hunting expeditions, mirroring the], [Finish the article on AICN], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 288, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

{

## ANALYSIS

shrouded in mystery, stalking a decadent club like a knock-off John Wick. We see all the impressive cloak-and-dagger of a seedy underworld and we're intrigued. Unfortunately the job goes awry and Tommy is forced to flee London, with little else than the briefest of goodbyes to his son, for his homeland of the United States of America. Los Angeles, to be precise, where he subsists on minor hit jobs for the despicable Benson (Hoffman). Benson reviles everyone around him, from his mail-order bride to his sensitive son, Julian (Taylor). Envious of Ward's effortless cool and natural masculinity, Benson pairs Ward with Julian in an effort to help the boy become a man.], [This film really works for its two], [Finish the article on AICN], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 284, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [PILLION Beautifully Blends Humor, Poignancy, and Biker Butts], author: [Barbarella], source-name: [Ain't It Cool News], images: (), paragraphs: ( [PILLION Beautifully Blends Humor, Poignancy, and Biker Butts], [Read the full article on AICN], [Hey friends, Barbarella here. Step aside predictable rom-coms, there's a new game in town: the dom-com. It's awkward and joyful, sensual and somewhat cruel, offering a variety of experiences for a viewer. PILLION proves to be my first experience with a dom-com, and I love it! Is that love due to the storyline, the depth of the characters, the family relationships, or was it just how incredibly titillating Alexander Skarsgård is as Ray, the gay biker who finds a devoted partner in Harry Melling's Colin? I can't say for certain, but the latter definitely factors into the equation. There may not be as much poignancy as bare biker butts in Harry Lighton's film, but to my pleasant surprise, there's plenty.], [The film artfully portrays the way an awkward a cappella singer so quickly falls under a dominant biker's spell. One thing I so love about this movie is that even though there isn't a ton of time delving into the characters' psyches, the audience can still glean plenty from what's not said or explored on screen. Both actors dive into the roles with abandon, making it clear that in this case, hiring straight actors to play gay roles completely makes sense. I can't think of another actor, straight or gay, who could be so convincing in the role of Ray as Alexander Skarsgård proves to be. His looks combined with his soft-spoken, commanding demeanor make it 100% believable that Colin would continue to stick around, despite wanting something more than what], [Finish the article on AICN], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 270, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

---

## IN BRIEF

**Owen Gleiberman, Variety:** In “The Last Critic,” we meet Christgau as an elder statesman of rock-crit (he’s now 83), a downtown stalwart knocking around the streets of the East Village. He’s a bit more bent than he was, with white hair and a touch of arthritis, but he’s still a wry specimen, lean and mean, with a machine-gun mind, ageless in his vigor (and in his hunger for new music).

**Marcus Jones, IndieWire:** The 2026 Emmys is coming with a handful of rule changes, one of which makes it hard to feel great about the state of late night TV.

**The Onion Staff, The Onion:** The post New Epstein Estate Photo Shows Trump Waterskiing In Pyramid Formation With Underage Girls appeared first on The Onion .

**Rafael Motamayor, /Film:** Rebecca Ferguson is the star of Apple TV’s sci-fi show Silo, but her involvement as an executive producer means her love runs even deeper.

**Debopriya Dutta, /Film:** The Guyver, featuring Mark Hamill, evokes a slightly grown-up version of Power Rangers, which is enjoyable in itself if you completely ignore its manga roots.

**Afam Onyimadu, MakeUseOf:** Privacy is a main reason people de-Google, but for me, switching from Google Search was about more than privacy. I didn’t enjoy getting SEO-heavy results and listicles when I needed a simple debugging fix.

**Witney Seibold, /Film:** Most of the Star Trek: The Next Generation cast didn’t get to keep their uniform costumes. Jonathan Frakes, however, simply stole his.

**Devin Meenan, /Film:** Two of the darkest episodes of Battlestar Galactica were clearly influenced by another sci-fi story’s all timer of an ending.

**Bryan M. Wolfe, MakeUseOf:** We treat SD cards like digital vaults. They live in our cameras, Nintendo Switches, and Raspberry Pis for years, and we just assume that as long as the plastic casing isn’t cracked, our data is safe.

**Jim Hemphill, IndieWire:** William Friedkin built on giallo conventions when he made his 1980 thriller; 13 years later, Italian director Pierfrancesco Campanella returned the compliment with the film, now headed for physical media.

**Joe Roberts, /Film:** Smallville creators Alfred Gough and Miles Millar were once hired to write an Iron Man movie for Marvel, but it’s good that it never came to pass.

}

---

## The Bold Chronicle

Vol. 1, No. 055 · 2026-03-30

*Curated and composed automatically.*